

Gregory M. Cole, PE, ENV SP

SUMMARY:

More than your typical engineer with over 17 years experience. I don't accept "because" or "that's how we have always done it" as answers to why. Started in fisheries science wanting to be a fish farmer and wound up becoming a civil engineer. Have been the **designer, regulator, owner**, and the **contractor**. Shepherded the City of Charlotte's first large scale flood plain reclamation project with an \$11 million budget through planning, real estate, design, and bid phases. Created and permitted the civil site plans for a dam seismic retrofit project with a construction budget of \$16 million, a 150 acre borrow area, and over a million cubic yards of cut/fill. I delivered it on time and under budget while implementing a new CAD system. Then repeated that with a \$50 million dollar dam seismic retrofit project while training a senior civil engineer. Most comfortable leading a design team, working collaboratively with clients, and mentoring young professionals. My leadership principles include mutual respect, setting clear expectations, accountability, professionalism, and giving my team the tools to succeed.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE:

Quible & Associates, Black Mountain, NC **Senior Project Manager**

February 2018 – June 2018

- **Blue Ridge Village Stormwater Site Assessment, Banner Elk, NC**
Scoped and assessed status of the stormwater system on this approximately 25 acre resort property. Investigated status of environmental permits. Generated letter report with findings and recommendations for proceeding.
- **Open Ended Civil Engineering Contract, Asheville-Buncombe Technical Community College, Asheville, NC**
Prepared and submitted statement of qualifications. Served as primary point of contact and managed client relations. Scoped and prepared demolition bid documents. Solicited qualified bidders and conducted pre-bid site meetings.
- **Chandler Pond, Duncan's Creek, NC**
Investigated and presented various pond configurations and dam designs to maximize pond volume while fitting into the site constraints and reducing likelihood of dam being classified as high hazard. Assisted with soil infiltration testing.

Blythe Development Company, Charlotte, NC **Project Engineer**

September 2015 – February 2018

- **Providence Farm Projects and Village At Rea Farms Project.**
Blythe Development is the grading contractor on these projects. They are multifamily and retail projects with sites over 60 acres and grading budgets over \$5 million. My duties include tracking quantities, helping prepare pay applications, assessing communicating plan revisions, coordinating with General Contractor, permitting, and whatever else the project manager or superintendents need.
- **Charlotte Douglas Elevated Roadway and Underground Passageway Project**
This is a \$40 million project to move the roads serving the main entrance of the CDIA terminal without interrupting service to passengers. Locate underground utilities which were not always recorded, could be buried over 20 feet down, and included the primary communication duct connecting CDIA to other airports and FAA. Tracked production quantities, took off plan quantities, negotiated and contracted with suppliers and subcontractors, permitting.

City of Charlotte Storm Water Services, Charlotte, NC **Project Manager**

June 2007 – August 2015

- **Blenhein Storm Drainage Improvement Project, \$8 million budget**
This was my favorite project as it had the largest impact on the community relocating over 20 families out of flood prone houses and creating neighborhood amenity while improving water quality. Project was the City of Charlotte's **first large scale floodplain reclamation project** requiring the purchasing and demolition of over 20 houses. This is why the project was stuck in planning for several years before being assigned to me. I got it moving again and finished planning then design, real estate, and bid phase. I managed the consultants and surveyors, conducted public meetings, and other duties. Required me to get the support of numerous stake holders including residents and the City council member.
- **Hunter Acres Pond Improvement Project, \$2 million budget**

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Managed this water quality project from conception through end of construction. It required the **removal and replacement of a high hazard dam and the roadway**. Negotiated with the neighborhood association for easements, managed permitting with State agencies, managed engineering consultant. This project is of note due to negotiations required with the community, City agencies, and the need to replace the contractor during construction.

- Also managed two other dam projects with combined budgets of over **\$3 million dollars**.
- Also managed three other storm drainage projects with project areas from **200 acres to over 400 acres** and initial budget projections of **\$10-12 million dollars each**.

Additional Duties

- Evaluate/analyze stormwater and watershed metrics to determine project boundaries and scope
- Lead public meetings and facilitate communication between all stakeholders including consultants, City staff, and residents
- Work with State regulators to get projects permitted (first high hazard dam project by the City)
- Mentor fellow stormwater staff while transitioning projects and serving as a peer member
- Collaborate with Neighborhood Improvement Projects to address citizen concerns and minimize impacts
- Coordinate and collaborate with other City departments executing projects in the same areas
- Lead the Dam Safety ETA for three years and served on technical committees

Devine Tarbell & Associates, Charlotte, NC

Aug 2003 – June 2007

Engineer Catawba Dam ESSI Project

Oct 2006 – June 2007

- **Embankment Seismic Stability Improvement (ESSI)**
- \$50 million dollar construction budget, 250 Acre project area
- Led effort to update civil engineering software from 2D to 3D.
- Designed and prepared site work construction drawings on time and under budget.
- Worked with state agencies to obtain required stormwater permits.
- Trained new design team members (including a senior civil engineer) to prepare site designs and perform environmental site inspections.

Assistant Resident Engineer Paddy Creek Dam ESSI Project Construction

Jan 2005 – June 2007

- Served as onsite Resident Engineer in Resident Engineer's absence.
- Convinced team to convert waste product of clearing operations (wood mulch) into useful soil stabilizer and additive.
- Performed site inspections and worked with contractor ensuring construction activities were in compliance with specifications and stormwater permits.
- Obtained regulatory approval from the State for changes to site design.
- Prepared as-built drawings and weekly project meeting summaries.

Associate Engineer for Paddy Creek Dam ESSI Project Design

Aug 2003 - Jan 2005

- Prepared construction specifications pertaining to erosion and sediment control and site stabilization for Paddy Creek Dam ESSI Project
- Coordinated CAD production with design teams and implemented file structure standards
- Coordinated design efforts, and provided quality control for erosion and sediment control design subcontractor
- Wrote scope of work documents and managed surveying subcontractors
- Produced cost estimates for seismic remediation efforts
- Assisted with 404/401 Permitting and Dillsboro dam removal assessment

EDUCATION:

Bachelor of Science - Civil Engineering

May 2001

Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA

Concentration: Environmental and Water Resources

Bachelor of Science - Forestry and Wildlife Science

May 1997

Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA

Concentration: Fisheries Science

Minors: Biology, Environmental Science

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CERTIFICATIONS & ACTIVITIES:

- Professional Engineer (PE) Licensed in North Carolina
- Institute for Sustainable Infrastructure certified Envision Sustainability Professional (ENV SP)
- APWA Stormwater Management Conference 2018
- Welcome to MDC – 2018 NC Stormwater Minimum Design Criteria training lead by Bill Hunt
- Project Management Professional (PMP) (expired 2016)
- Member North Carolina Sustainable Energy Association (NCSEA)
- NC Sustainable Energy Association Conference - Making Energy Work 2012
- 2014 EcoStream Conference - Stream Ecology and Restoration
- Executive Board Member, Coventry Woods Neighborhood Association 2006 to 2010
- WRRI: Erosion and Sedimentation Control Planning and Design Workshop (2007)

CONTACT INFORMATION:

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